

Audit a workflow you already run

Pick a real workflow from your job — manual or automated. Run it through the agent-readiness rubric with ChatGPT. Answer one question by the end: should this become an agent, or stay as it is?

WHY THIS EXERCISE

Most "AI use cases" your team will propose are actually workflows in disguise. The skill is being able to tell the difference before three months of build time. By the end of this, you will have audited a real workflow and produced a verdict you can defend in a stand-up.

1 Pick a workflow you actually own (3 min)

Pick something **you** currently do or maintain. Not hypothetical. Examples:

- A weekly report you compile manually.
- A ticket-triage process your team does in Slack.
- An onboarding checklist you walk new hires through.
- A Zapier or Power Automate flow you set up.
- A spreadsheet macro or Python script you maintain.

Write down, in one paragraph: **what it does, who triggers it, and what the output is.** Three sentences max.

2 Run the readiness audit with ChatGPT (10 min)

Open ChatGPT and paste this prompt. Substitute your workflow description from Step 1.

PROMPT TO PASTE INTO CHATGPT

I am auditing a workflow to decide whether it should become an agentic AI system. Here is the workflow:

[PASTE YOUR ONE-PARAGRAPH WORKFLOW DESCRIPTION HERE]

Run this six-question audit. Give me one short answer per question and a single-sentence justification.

1. Is the next step decided by code (a rule, a schedule, an if/else) or by a model that has to interpret context?
2. Does the workflow have a single step or multiple steps?
3. Are tool side effects required (writes to a database, sending an email, charging a card) or is text generation enough?
4. Across two identical runs on identical input, is variance in the OUTCOME (not the wording) acceptable, or must outcomes be identical?
5. If something goes wrong halfway, what reverses? Be specific.
6. What is the worst thing that could happen if this system confidently lied about what it did?

After the six answers, give your verdict in this format:

- Recommended shape: [Automation | Workflow | LLM Call | Agent]
- Confidence: [Low | Medium | High]
- The single biggest reason: [one sentence]

3 Challenge the verdict (8 min)

Whatever shape ChatGPT recommended, push back. The point is to find the cracks before someone else does.

PROMPT TO PASTE NEXT

Now play devil's advocate. Argue the opposite of your own verdict.

- If you said "agent," argue why this could be a simpler workflow.
- If you said "workflow," argue why an agent might be justified.
- If you said "automation" or "LLM call," argue both directions.

Give me three reasons for the opposite shape. Be specific to my workflow, not generic.

Then, with both sides on the table, give your FINAL verdict. Same format as before. If you changed your mind, say what changed it.

4 Identify the one failure pattern that bites hardest (5 min)

Whatever the final verdict, your workflow has one weakness that matters most. Find it.

PROMPT TO PASTE NEXT

Given your final verdict, identify the ONE failure mode most likely to bite this system in production. Use these categories:

- Looping (repeats forever)
- Silent failure (errors but reports success)
- Hallucinated step (claims an action it didn't take)
- Context poisoning (mixes up users or sessions)
- State drift (loses track of progress)
- Unsafe autonomy (irreversible action without approval)
- Other (specify)

Then give me:

- The exact log line or metric I should add today to detect it
- The one test I should write to make sure the defence does not regress

5 Self-verify before you stop (2 min)

Run this checklist before you close ChatGPT.

- ☐ My workflow description is a real thing I do, not hypothetical.
- ☐ ChatGPT answered all six audit questions with one-sentence justifications.
- ☐ The first verdict named a specific quadrant with a confidence level.
- ☐ The devil's advocate round produced at least three specific opposing reasons.
- ☐ The FINAL verdict either reaffirmed the first one (with stronger reasoning) or changed it (with a clear cause).
- ☐ The failure pattern named is specific to MY workflow, not generic.
- ☐ The log line / metric is concrete enough to implement today.

WHAT YOU WALK AWAY WITH

A one-paragraph audit of a real workflow you own. A verdict (probably "keep as workflow" — most things are). One concrete log line to add Monday morning. **If your verdict was "upgrade to agent," you now have the start of a PRD — the eight questions from Half 2 are your next step.**

IF YOU FINISH EARLY

Do the same audit on a SECOND workflow. Compare the two. The patterns you spot across both will surface what your team actually needs from agentic AI versus what it just needs from better automation.